LS1: YOU AND YOUR COMPANY

PEOPLE AND THEIR COMPANIES

In the world of work, you will need to be able to present basic information about yourself, your company and your job. Sometimes, there are situations in which you have to speak English spontaneously. It is important to learn the vocabulary and skills in case you need to greet an English-speaking visitor, give a factory or workshop tour to international colleagues or talk to a supplier from another country.

Task 1: People and their work.

Listen to the five people and match them with pictures.

Christina| Marcus| Sven| Mandy | Daniela

1

2

3

4

5

Task 2: Detailed Information

Listen again and complete the sentences.

1) Sven's company makes cutting devices that are used in X.
2) Christina works at a X. She is learning how to handle X and their technologies.
3) Marcus works at a firm that manufactures X. He works in the X.
4) Mandy's employer is an X company.
5) Daniela is an X specialist. Her apprenticeship focuses on X.

Task 3: Your place of work

Think of a typical situation at your company and use it to introduce yourself and your place of work to a partner. You could use a picture and describe what it shows.

Quick language help:

Phrases

I'm an apprentice/trainee/intern at …
I'm doing an apprenticeship/traineeship/internship at …
My company is …/works with …
I work at …
I'm learning to …/training to be …

Major language help:

1. Introducing Yourself

- "Hello, my name is [Name], and I'm an apprentice at [Company]."
- "I'm currently training to become a [IT salesman / system administrator / programmer]."
- "I've been working here for [X months / years]."
- "Nice to meet you! I'm part of the [department name] team."

2. Talking About Your Workplace

- "Our company specializes in [software solutions / IT services / cloud computing]."
- "We have a small/large office with [number] of employees."
- "In our office, we have [workstations / servers / meeting rooms]."
- "This picture shows our [workspace / server room / sales team]."

3. Describing Your Role

Expressions for IT Sales:

- "I help our clients find the right IT solutions for their needs."
- "I communicate with customers by email and phone."
- "I'm learning how to present products and negotiate contracts."

Expressions for Administrators:

- "I maintain our computer systems and networks."
- "I make sure that the software is running smoothly."
- "I help colleagues solve technical problems."

Expressions for Programmers:

- "I write and test code for our software projects."
- "I work on [applications / websites / internal tools]."
- "I collaborate with other programmers and designers."

4. Describing a Picture of Your Workplace

Expressions:

- "In this picture, you can see our [office / team / workspace]."
- "Here we have [people working on computers / a meeting / a server room]."
- "This shows a typical day at our company, where we [develop software / talk to clients / manage systems]."